

YUJIN ZHANG

CONTACT INFORMATION

Department of Political Science
Columbia University
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EDUCATION

Columbia University in the City of New York, NY 2027 (Expected)
Ph.D., Political Science
– Fields: International Relations (Major), Comparative Politics
– Dissertation: Early-Life Experiences and Global Public Opinion on Economic Policymaking
– Dissertation Committee: Allison Carnegie (Co-Chair), Nikhar Gaikwad (Co-Chair), Junyan Jiang, Calvin Thrall
M. Phil., Political Science 2022
M.A., Political Science 2020
SAIS, Johns Hopkins University, Washington, D.C. 2018
M.A., International Political Economy and International Economics
Colorado State University, Fort Collins, CO 2016
B.A., magna cum laude, Business Administration
Hunan University, Changsha, Hunan, China 2014
B.A., Finance

RESEARCH INTEREST

Research Focus: International political economy, transformation of the international economic order, economic security and statecraft, political socialization
Regional Focus: East Asia, Developed Economies

PUBLICATION

- [2] **Zhang, Yujin.** 2026. “Inflation of Populism: Effects of Early Economic Experiences on Support for Populist Parties.” *Economics & Politics*, Early View.
– Keywords: Inflation, Populism, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, European Politics
[1] 2024. Ji, Chengyuan, Junyan Jiang, **Yujin Zhang.** “Political Trust and Government Performance in the Time of COVID-19.” *World Development* 176 (106499).
– Keywords: Health governance, political trust

REVISE & RESUBMIT

- [2] **Zhang, Yujin.** “Assistance to Me, and to Thee: Early Inequality Experiences and Public Preferences for Overseas Aid.” *Revise and Resubmit at International Studies Quarterly.* [Link](#).
– Keywords: Foreign Aid, Inequality, Early Experiences, Public Opinion, Developed Countries
[1] **Zhang, Yujin.** “Prosperity and Openness: Early Globalization Experiences and Mass Preferences for Free Trade.” *Revise and Resubmit at Comparative Political Studies.* (Job Market Paper). [Link](#).
– Keywords: Trade preferences, Formative Experiences, Public Opinion, East and South-east Asia
– Presentations: APSA 2024, MPSA 2024

UNDER REVIEW

- [2] **Zhang, Yujin** and Ziwen Zu. “Rethinking Backlash against Trade Openness: Import–Export Preferences in Two Dimensions.” [Link](#).
 – Previous Title: “Why Mercantilism? Preferences for Trade Surplus and Mercantilist Policies”
 – Keywords: Globalization Backlash, Mercantilism, Isolationism, Survey Experiment, United States and China
 – Presentations: APSA 2026, GSIPE-APSA 2026, ISA 2026, IPES 2025
- [1] **Zhang, Yujin** and Ziwen Zu. “Collaborative Competition? The Efficiency-Risk Dilemma and Public Preferences for International Technological Transfer.” [Link](#).
 – Keywords: Technological preferences; Economic Security; Geopolitical Competition; the United States; Survey experiment
 – Presentations: APSA 2026, ISA 2026, IPES 2025

WORKING PAPER

- [2] **Zhang, Yujin**. “Partisan Responses to Economic Shocks: Inflation Crises and the Paradox of Trade Liberalization.” [Link](#).
 – Keywords: Inflation crisis, trade liberalization, political parties, electoral politics
 – Presentations: APSA 2025, MPSA 2025
- [1] **Zhang, Yujin**. “Aversion to What?: Early-Life Economic Experiences and Responses to Inflation.” [Link](#).
 – Keywords: Formative experiences, macroeconomic attitudes, Europe
 – Presentations: APSA 2023

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

- [4] “Nationalist, United?”
 [3] “On Industrial Policies.”
 [2] “Environmental and Electoral Consequences of the Trade War.”
 [1] “Life Experiences and Attitudes toward Military Alliance.” with Allison Carnegie and Elizabeth Saunders.

POLICY PUBLICATION

- [1] 2018. “China’s Coal-to-Gas Program: A Developing Environmental Governance Regime.” *SAIS Review of International Affairs*. [Link](#).

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Columbia University

Politics of International Economic Relations, Prof. Jeffrey Frieden Fall 2024
 Chinese Politics, Prof. Junyan Jiang Fall 2021, Spring 2023
 China’s Foreign Relations, Prof. Thomas Christensen Spring 2021, Fall 2022, Spring 2025
 International Politics, Prof. Alexander de la Paz Spring 2022
 Autocracy and Democracy, Prof. Timothy Frye Fall 2020

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University

Advanced Topics in International Trade (Graduate), Prof. Hiau Looi Kee Spring 2018

RESEARCH ASSISTANCE

Columbia University

Prof. Nikhar Gaikwad 2022-25
 Prof. Junyan Jiang 2021-23, 25

SAIS, Johns Hopkins University

Prof. Ling Chen 2017-19
 Prof. David Steinberg 2018-19

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS	External	
	Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies (\$6500)	2024, 26
	Finalist, NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars	2024, 26
	Expense Support Grant, Institute for Humane Studies (\$7500)	2025
	Travel Grant, Graduate Students in International Political Economy	2022
	Travel Grant, International Studies Association	2019
	Columbia University	
	C. Martin Wilbur Fellowship	2025-26
	CPE Graduate Student Grant (\$7000)	2025-26
	Dissertation Fellowship	2023-24
	Travel Grant	2023-26
	Teaching Fellowship	2020-23, 24
	Weatherhead East Asian Institute Fellowship	2019-20
	SAIS, Johns Hopkins University	
	SAIS Fellowship	2017-18
CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS	2026: APSA $c,d \times 3, p \times 2$ $\diamond$ GSIPE-APSA Pre-Conference Workshop $\diamond$ ISA $c, p \times 2$ $\diamond$ IHS Trade Workshop 2025: IPES $p \times 2$ $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ MPSA d, p 2024: Virtual International Political Economy Society $\diamond$ NY/PANJ AAPOR Young Public Opinion Stars $\diamond$ GSIPE Mini-Conference $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ APSA $\diamond$ MPSA 2023: Northeast Regional Workshop in European Politics $\diamond$ GSIPE d, p $\diamond$ APSA 2022: GSIPE APSA Workshop 2021: Political Science Speaker Series 2019: ISA 2018: MPSA	
	$*c = \text{Chair}, d = \text{Discussant}, p = \text{Paper}$	
SKILLS	Languages: Mandarin (Native) Programming: R, Stata, L ^A T _E X, Python, LLM API integration Methods: Survey design, experiment design, conjoint analysis	
SERVICE	Event Coordinator, Graduate Student in International Political Economy	2024-25
REFeree	<i>Policy Studies / Social Science Research / World Development</i>	
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	The US-China Business Council China Africa Research Initiative The Woodrow Wilson International Center for Scholars The Brookings Institution	2018-19 2016-17, 2018-19 2018 2018

REFERENCES

Allison Carnegie

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Nikhar Gaikwad

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Calvin Thrall

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